

May

18

1804

Emperor Napoleon

After conquering much of Europe, French military leader Napoleon Bonaparte became the self-appointed emperor of France. He introduced government reforms, but constant battles overseas led to his downfall.



Also on this day

1291 The city of Acre, the last stronghold of Christian Crusaders in the Holy Land, was captured by Muslim forces.

1893 Meri Te Tai Mangakāhia became the first woman to speak to the all-male Māori Parliament in New Zealand.

1991 The first British astronaut – 27-year-old Helen Sharman – travelled to the *Mir* space station on a Soyuz spacecraft.

Lawnmower deal

Trimming lawns became easier after inventor Edwin Budding and manufacturer John Ferrabee struck a deal to start making the world's first lawnmowers in Gloucestershire, UK.

1830



Born this day

1955 Chow Yun-fat, Chinese actor and screenwriter. He starred in the Oscar-winning movie *Crouching Tiger, Hidden Dragon*.

1970 Tina Fey, US actor, comedian, and writer. She found fame as a presenter and performer on US TV show *Saturday Night Live*.

1927

Hollywood cinema

Thousands lined Hollywood Boulevard in Los Angeles, USA, for the opening of Grauman's Chinese Theatre.

The famous cinema has hosted many movie premieres, including *Star Wars* in 1977.

